

School of Communication
University of Miami
STC 116
Principles of Public Relations
Section GH, 2:30PM - 3:45PM, MW, Whitten LC 160
Fall 2026

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Office Hours:	Mondays, 3:50 - 4:50 PM & by pre-scheduled appointment (in person/zoom)

*** Please email me at least 24 hours in advance to schedule a Zoom meeting.**
*** Email is often the best way to contact me. Start with STC 116 in your email's subject line.** I usually check my email twice throughout the day (at 4:00 pm, and then 8:00 pm). Make sure you email me before these hours, if you need my quick reply.

SYLLABUS

COURSE DESCRIPTION AND PURPOSE

UM Bulletin

History, organization, ethics, law, and practice of public relations.

Detailed Course Description

Throughout the tenure of this course you will learn about the theory and practice of public relations, how public relations operates within organizations, its impact on publics and its functions in society. You will study the professional development of the field; concepts, issues and principles in the practice; and models of theories guiding the practice. You will also be challenged to critically evaluate the practice and purpose of public relations in contemporary American society.

For those planning public relations careers, this course provides the foundation for your role as a successful professional communicator. The course also meets the needs of those planning other professional and managerial careers that require an understanding of public relations concepts and management practices.

Course Objective

To attain knowledge and understanding of the following central concepts:

- Role and functions of public relations in an industrialized society
- Concepts of public relations, audience analyses, and persuasion
- Basic process of public relations—research, planning, communication, evaluation—and the use of communication strategies to achieve organizational objectives
- Practical guidelines for utilizing written, spoken and visual techniques to reach selected audiences
- Understanding of public relations activities in firms, corporations, social agencies, trade organizations, government, education, not-for-profits and sports and entertainment.
- Historical evolution and new directions for public relations practice, career opportunities in the field, and professional, ethical and legal responsibilities
- Good listening and presentation skills and problem-solving abilities

- Professional verbal and written communication capabilities

Canvas & Class Communication

Most class materials such as PowerPoint® slides, readings, assignments, final project instructions and evaluation rubrics, and earned student grades will be posted on Canvas (<https://www.courses.miami.edu/>). Please check the site **frequently**. You can access Canvas using your CaneID and password. It is **your responsibility to keep up** with the class assignments and materials, and monitor your progress via Canvas. If you ever have questions about your grade, check your Canvas status first. It is also your responsibility to ensure that **your preferred email address is found on MyUM**. This is the address where you will find Canvas correspondence.

Please note that to make class communication easier for students, some class meetings (e.g., guest lectures, student presentations, etc.) will be delivered via Zoom on Canvas. In those meetings, all students must try their best to secure stable Internet connection to access Canvas and Zoom. If you have trouble accessing Canvas, please seek help from Help Desk: 305-284-3949 or learningplatforms@miami.edu. Additionally, in those zoom class meetings, students are required to have their **camera video enabled**, unless the professor instructs otherwise. If you have a legitimate reason for not being able to employ camera video during those zoom meetings, please email the instructor as soon as possible for advance approval. In very rare situations where the instructor is not able to access the Internet to deliver the lecture (e.g., due to unexpected power outage), the instructor will record the lecture content and upload the recording to Canvas once the Internet becomes accessible. Students are required to watch the recording once it is available.

Course Recording

Lectures will NOT be recorded unless requested by students in advance and approved by the professor. Please email the professor your request for recording **at least 48 hours** before the specific lecture.

Course recordings will be available to ONLY students registered for this class, as they are intended to supplement the classroom experience. To maintain your privacy and the privacy of the other students in the course, the sharing of the recorded lecture materials posted on Canvas is **not** permitted.

Students are expressly **prohibited from recording any part of this course**. Meetings of this course might be recorded by the University. Any recordings will be available to students registered for this class as they are intended to supplement the classroom experience. Students are expected to follow appropriate University policies and maintain the security of passwords used to access recorded lectures. Recordings may not be reproduced, shared with those not in the class, or uploaded to other online environments. If the instructor or a University of Miami office plans any other uses for the recordings, beyond this class, students identifiable in the recordings will be notified to request consent prior to such use.

Intellectual Property and Copyright of Class Materials

Pursuant to the University's Policy on Inventions, Intellectual Property, and Technology Transfer, "courseware" includes: course syllabi, assignments, assessments, and/or other materials that are first created and made available to students as part of the educational curriculum at the University. Courseware is owned by the faculty member, unless otherwise agreed to beforehand in a written contract between the University and the faculty member. This policy and position have not changed due to recent circumstances and this policy and definitions apply to all means by which the course material is provided.

Professor Weiting Tao is the copyright owner of the courseware, which include but are not limited to lecture PowerPoint® Slides, assignments, handouts, final project instructions and samples, and exam questions. Individual recordings of the materials on Canvas and/or of the virtual sessions are **not**

allowed; and that such materials **cannot be shared** outside the physical or virtual classroom environment.

Class Format

This course is outcome-based. You will be evaluated primarily on your ability to: 1) master the theories and knowledge shared in class, and 2) transfer them into workable solutions. Since there is no one single solution to any public relations problem, we will be looking at public relations from a variety of angles throughout the semester. Topics will include the development of the public relations field; the role of public relations in organizations and society, nationally and internationally; ethical and legal considerations involved in the practice of public relations; special topics; and contemporary trends and issues.

COURSE PREREQUISITES

None

MATERIAL FEES

None

TEXTS AND RESOURCES REQUIRED

Dennis L. Wilcox, Bryan H. Reber, Jae-Hwa Shin, and Glen T. Cameron. *Public Relations: Strategies and Tactics*, 12th Edition. Pearson, 2023. (Hard Cover/e-book)

Book link: <https://www.pearson.com/en-us/subject-catalog/p/public-relations-strategies-and-tactics/P200000006759/9780137945511>

While there is only one required text for the course, additional required readings will be assigned, as needed. Students may quickly fall behind and, therefore, are strongly advised to stay current with the reading assignments. Major reading assignments have been listed in the course schedule.

Assigned readings should be completed **prior to class**. Students should come to online class session with the assigned readings' concepts both in memory and in written reading notes. Be prepared to discuss them intelligently in class. **Students' class prep efforts will be evaluated via quizzes.** Students should consider regularly reading the following publications: *Public Relations Tactics*, *Public Relations Strategist*, *PR Week*, *Communication World*, *Harvard Business Review*, *The Wall Street Journal*, *The Washington Post*, and *The New York Times*.

COURSE PROFESSIONALISM CODES

The School of Communication is a professional school and professional decorum is expected at all times. Therefore, both the professor and students adhere to workplace norms for collegial and respectful interaction.

The professor reserves the right to penalize any students who do not follow the following guidelines and who disrupt the class (via a 5-point final grade deduction for each occurrence).

- Students are expected to attend every class, arrive on time, NOT leave early, and wait for the class to end before packing to leave, unless prior permission is granted by the professor (see the Class Attendance Policy in this syllabus).

- Cell phones, iPods, iPads, and other devices must be turned off completely BEFORE class; silent mode or vibrate is NOT considered off. Laptops may be used ONLY as a note-taking device.
- Surfing the Internet, checking or creating emails, checking social media, playing games, watching videos, doing assignments for other classes, and conducting activities not related to this class are strictly prohibited. Anyone who engages in these activities will be requested to leave his/her devices in the professor's care.
- Students are expected to conduct themselves in an honest, ethical and courteous manner – with classmates and the professor. Eating, drinking and privately chatting in class do NOT demonstrate professional behavior. Talking while the professor or another student is talking is unacceptable; such actions can result in being asked to leave the classroom and will result in a lowering of your final grade.
- Students are NOT permitted to bring guests to class unless special arrangements have been made with the professor prior to class. Students are NOT allowed to record class lectures or place/distribute class materials (esp. online) without the professor's permission.
- When attending the online lectures, students should choose a distraction-free environment to allow themselves to fully focus on class lectures and discussions, whenever possible.
- During the online lecture, students should mute their microphone unless they need to or are asked to talk to the class. This is necessary to eliminate background noise from students' end.
- Any evidence of plagiarism or cheating will result in an "F" for the course (i.e., fail the course) and possible disciplinary action. Do not submit the same work to more than one class. Do not adapt work from another class for this class. Do not adapt someone else's work and submit it as your own. This course requires original work, created at this time, for this purpose.
- Using **Artificial Intelligence** tools (e.g., chat GPT, etc.) to assist and/or complete course assignments is not only a violation of the UM Honor Code; it will also NOT prepare you for the industry you hope to enter after graduation. Any evidence of using such tools to assist and/or complete course assignments will result in an "F" for the course (i.e., fail the course) and possible disciplinary action.
- Please be aware that a student who attends class irregularly, comes to class late, leaves class early, fails to complete assignments, quizzes, exams, and other class requirements on time or neglects assigned readings can normally expect to earn a low grade.

GRADES ARE EARNED

In the advertising and public relations industries, success is determined by the final output—work that reflects research, strategic thinking, creative solutions, and professional execution. Simply put, the hours invested do not directly correlate with the grade earned. Grades are awarded based on producing high-quality work that meets industry standards. Effort alone does not guarantee an A. Delivering exceptional, polished work that meets or exceeds expectations is essential for achieving As in Strategic Communication courses.

GRADING

The course grade will be based on the following components **minus any penalties incurred as a result of failing to follow class rules:**

- Attendance and Class Contribution: 5%
- In-Class Pop-Up Activities: 5%
- Quizzes: 20%
- Individual Assignments: 10%
- Discussion Leader Assignments: 5%
- Exam One (Chapters 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7 & other sources): 30%
- Exam Two (Chapters 8, 9, 11, 12,, 14, 15, 18 & other sources): 25%

Grading Scale:

97%-100%	A+	97-100 pts	70%-76%	C	70-76 pts
94%-96%	A	94-100 pts	67%-69%	D+	67-69 pts
90%-93%	A-	90-93 pts	64%-66%	D	64-66 pts
87%-89%	B+	87-89 pts	60%-63%	D-	60-63 pts
84%-86%	B	84-86 pts	below 60%	F	0-59 pts
80%-83%	B-	80-83 pts	Incomplete	I	
77%-79%	C+	77-79 pts			

*pts = points.

The professor does NOT round grades up or drop the lowest test/assignment score.
No extra credit work will be allowed, except those announced by the professor.

48-Hour Rule

If you would like to discuss and/or appeal an assigned grade during the course of this semester, you must make an appointment to see me. Your appointment to meet will be scheduled no sooner than 48 hours after receiving the grade in question. Prepare a short paragraph outlining your position; submit that paragraph to me for review when requesting the appointment.

Grades are Earned

In the public relations industry, success is determined by the final output—work that reflects research, strategic thinking, creative solutions, and professional execution. Simply put, the hours invested do not directly correlate with the grade earned. Grades are awarded based on producing high-quality work that meets industry standards. Effort alone does not guarantee an A. Delivering exceptional, polished work that meets or exceeds expectations is essential for achieving A's in strategic Communication courses.

Course Evaluation

At some point during the final weeks of the class you will be asked to evaluate the course content and my instruction. This is your opportunity to let me know what you like and/or dislike about the course, and also provide me with ways you think the course can be improved in the future. I value your judgment and will use your constructive criticism to tweak the course and coursework, so please be open and honest in your assessment.

ASSIGNMENTS/COURSEWORK

Class Attendance Policy

The essence of this course is class lecture and participation. This class will include an extensive class discussion element, the purpose of which is to expose learners to numerous and diverse perspectives that will foster a greater understanding of our complex global market/society. Information covered in class lectures may NOT appear in assigned readings; therefore attendance is most crucial for success in this course. All material covered in class, via lectures, videos, and assigned readings can (and will) be used as examination material.

Punctual attendance at all class meetings is expected. Your attendance to each class meeting will be monitored and recorded. For each unexcused occurrence of absence, late arrival, or early departure, a 5-point final grade deduction will apply.

Excused Absence: You may miss a class, arrive late, or depart early ONLY in the following three situations and ONLY if you notify the professor promptly and are granted with **prior approval** from the professor. The penalty (i.e., 5-point final course grade deduction) will apply if you fail to notify and obtain approval from the professor well in advance, and/or if you fail to submit **certified documentation** to the professor **within 14 days immediately following your absence**. Attendance will be recorded starting from **August 26, 2026**.

- A student has a verifiable medical excuse which consists of written documentation from a medical provider such as the Student Health Center or a physician confirming the absence was due to illness or hospitalization. You must **notify the professor for approval** when immediate excuse is needed owing to sickness;
- If at some point in the semester you cannot physically attend class sessions due to illness, you must notify the professor prior to your absence. Unexcused absences from the classroom may affect your grade or lead to failing the course.
- personal or immediate family legal conditions warranting your attention during class time, certified by an attorney or judge and approved by the professor in advance;
- university business certified by a university official and approved by the professor in advance.

On the first day of the class, you should check important dates listed on the Course Schedule. These dates include but are not limited to exam dates, presentation dates, and assignment due dates. If a pre-arranged event (e.g., traveling back to campus, family wedding, or religious holy days) conflicts with any of these dates, students should notify the professor **within the first three class days (i.e., by Aug. 26, the latest)**. **Absences not pre-arranged within the first three class days are considered unexcused** and there is no obligation to allow any make-up or early work including exams, presentations, and such on. Students should submit necessary certified documents to the professor for approval. The professor may or may not approve the absence, depending on the eligibility of the event.

Student is responsible for all information presented in the classroom regardless of his or her presence or selected learning option. For all class work missed, student should consult with classmates, rather than the instructor, to obtain information on lectures, assignments, and other matters.

Class Contribution

You are expected to read assigned material **before** class and to participate in class. The professor's role in this class is one of collaborator, facilitator, and coach. In other words, share thoughts,

suggestions, criticisms, disagreement...but, whatever you do, talk in class – one person at a time. This portion of the grading is subjective. You can only earn full credit if you consistently contribute to the class through constructive and meaningful comments AND if you accomplish all the in-class activities following the professor's instruction. Class contribution grades will be posted on Canvas at the end of the semester.

In-Class Pop-Up Activities

There will be in-class, pop-up activities throughout the semester. For example, students may be asked to post their answers unto Canvas's Assignment tab within a short time frame (e.g., 15 minutes) during the lecture. Also, please be ready to present your answers to the class when **called upon** by the instructor. These pop-ups will NOT be announced in advance. The purpose is to test students' attentiveness to class lecture and students' memory recall and understanding of lecture points, and to promote class engagement. Pop-up activities come in a variety of forms. Students who miss any part of these pop-ups will receive a grade of zero. Grades for these pop-ups will be posted by the end of the semester.

Quizzes

Students are required to complete each open-book quiz listed under the **"Quizzes" tab on Canvas**. Quizzes are used to assess students' understanding of textbook chapters and class lectures. A quiz will be made available under the "Quizzes" tab, once the professor finishes the lecture associated with the quiz. Students can find the due day for each quiz in the Course Schedule. Quizzes contain true/false and multiple-choice questions.

Individual Assignments

Students are expected to complete **four** individual assignments on time (see the Course Schedule for deadlines). All assignments have been posted under the **"Assignments" tab on Canvas** for students to complete. It is your responsibility to ensure that your feedback is successfully posted and visible to the instructor for grading. If any technical issue emerges, you should contact Canvas Help Desk and have the issue fixed prior to the deadline of each assignment to ensure timely submission. **Do NOT email** the assignments to the professor. Grades for all the four individual assignments will be posted on Canvas.

Discussion Leader Assignments

Overview of Discussion Leader Assignments

Students are expected to complete two discussion leader assignments on time (see the Course Schedule for deadlines). Instructions for these discussion leader assignments have been posted under the **"Assignments" tab on Canvas** for students to complete. For the first assignment, you will be asked to write a reaction paper in an essay format, discussing a case study on corporate public relations. Different students will be assigned to different case studies chosen by the professor. For the second assignment, you will be asked to write a reaction paper on the topic of creativity in public relations.

Format of Discussion Leader Assignments

Every student is required to upload these two assignments to **Canvas's Assignment Tab** before the deadlines. **Do NOT email** the assignments to the professor. Each assignment should be two pages long, excluding references and title pages. See the ASSIGNMENT FORMAT session of this syllabus for basic format requirements.

In addition to uploading the assignments to Canvas, each student should prepare a **10-minute oral presentation per assignment**. The presentation will be held through Zoom on Canvas. It should cover all the key points from the student's assignment. Students may use PowerPoints or other visual aids to assist their presentations (via the "Share Screen" function on Zoom); these visual aids, however, are not mandatory. Students will be **randomly called upon** by the instructor to present their assignment during class sessions.

Exams

Two pre-announced, **closed-book** exams will be given during the semester. None are cumulative. Exam questions will come from all the following sources: readings in the textbooks, class lectures and discussions, students' assignments and presentations, videos, other assigned readings, and so on. Whether or not material in the textbook is discussed in class, students are responsible for all the assigned readings. Exam questions will be in the form of true/false and multiple choices.

On exam days, bring a #2 pencil, an eraser, and your Cane ID card to class, and remember your C-number correctly.

DEADLINES AND MAKEUP POLICY

Missing deadlines not only can damage a public relations or other professional's credibility, but also can lead to termination of a relationship with a client or to dismissal by an employer. Thus, deadlines are treated seriously in this class.

In most cases, there will be **no** make-up exams/quizzes, early exam/quizzes, or extensions of deadlines. Most due dates (except pop-up activity dates) have been **announced in advance in the Course Schedule** so that students can schedule other activities around these deadlines. Failure to complete/submit any work by deadlines will result in a grade of **zero**. Exceptions will be made only in cases of extraordinary, documented circumstances, as determined by the instructor (also see the Class Attendance Policy for a list of such circumstances). If you are granted with prior approval from the professor, you must provide **certified documentation** to the professor within **14 days** of the missed deadline.

ASSIGNMENT FORMAT

All written work submitted for this course must be coherent, logical, and carefully edited. Writing proficiency is necessary to pass this course. Misspellings, syntax and grammar errors as well as other writing problems are unacceptable in college writing. Do not submit materials with editing marks on them; all assignments must be **"client-ready."**

Unless otherwise specified, **all assignments must be typed with a 12-point Times New Roman font, single-spaced, and framed by one-inch margins. No handwritten** assignments will be accepted. APA or AP style guidelines must be followed. Any written assignment that does not follow the format guidelines will NOT be accepted and will be given a grade of zero.

Strong mechanical writing skills are expected from all students. Any assignment containing a **major factual error will receive a failing grade of 50 pts**. A major factual error is defined as one that gives the wrong information to the audience, including such things as misspelling terms and expressions, or incorrect identification of key sources. Errors which do a minor disservice to the reader will be graded somewhat more leniently, but remember **all factual errors will be considered serious**.

RELIGIOUS HOLY DAY POLICY

It is the student's obligation to provide faculty members with notice of the dates they will be absent for religious holy days, preferably before the beginning of classes but no later than the end of the first three (3) class days. Absences due to observance of religious holy days not pre-arranged within the first three class days may be considered unexcused and there is no obligation to allow any make up work, including but not limited to examinations and student presentations. Missing a class due to travel plans associated with a particular religious holy day does NOT constitute an excused absence. The University's complete Religious Holy Day Policy can be found in the current *UM Bulletin*.

HONOR CODE AND PLAGIARISM STATEMENTS

University of Miami students are required to follow the Student Honor Code. Academic integrity policy is strictly enforced. UM's Academic Integrity Policy is available at:

<https://dosso.studentaffairs.miami.edu/assets/pdf/honor-council/the-undergraduate-honor-code.pdf>

The purpose of the Honor Code is to protect the academic integrity of the University by encouraging consistent ethical behavior in assigned coursework. Academic dishonesty of any kind, for whatever reason, will not be tolerated.

No honest student wants to be guilty of the intellectual crime of plagiarism, even unintentionally. Therefore, we provide you with these guidelines so that you don't accidentally fall into the plagiarism trap.

Plagiarism is the taking of someone else's words, work, or ideas and passing them off as a product of your own efforts. Plagiarism may occur when a person fails to place quotation marks around someone else's exact words, directly rephrasing or paraphrasing someone else's words while still following the general form of the original, and/or failing to issue the proper citation to one's source material.

In student assignments, plagiarism is often due to...

- Turning in someone else's paper as one's own
- Using another person's data or ideas without acknowledgement
- Failing to cite a written source (printed or internet) of information that you used to collect data or ideas
- Copying an author's exact words and putting them in the paper without quotation marks
- Rephrasing an author's words and failing to cite the source
- Copying, rephrasing, or quoting an author's exact words and citing a source other than where the material was obtained. (For example, using a secondary source which cites the original material, but citing only the primary material. This misrepresents the nature of the scholarship involved in creating the paper. If you have not read an original publication, do not cite it in your references as if you have.)
- Using wording that is very similar to that of the original source, but passing it off as one's own.

The last item is probably the most common problem in student writing. It is still plagiarism if the student uses an author's key phrases or sentences in a way that implies they are his or her own, even if s/he cites the source.

Be careful to use ChatGPT or similar AI tools to cheat or get too much help on these kinds of AI tools. Using ChatGPT or similar AI tools on assignments is not only a violation of the UM Honor Code, but it also will not prepare students for the industry they hope to enter after graduation.

Policy of AI use

ChatGPT and other Generative Artificial Intelligence (AI) software may be useful tools for enhancing learning, productivity, and creativity. For instance, they can assist with brainstorming, finding information, and creating materials, such as text, images, and other media. However, these tools must be used appropriately and ethically, and you must understand their limitations. In particular, it is important to realize that all AI software has the following limitations:

How output is arrived at is not clear as the internal processes used to produce a particular output within the generative AI cannot be determined.

AI output is typically based on data harvested from unknown online sources. As such, it may reflect biases that should be acknowledged. AI output may also be inaccurate or entirely fabricated, even if it appears reliable or factual.

AI evokes a range of intellectual property concerns; sourcing and ownership of information is often unclear and is currently the subject of ongoing litigation.

If you use AI tools in any part of your work, you are responsible for the final product of that work, both academically and in the workforce.

Generative AI Principles

1. AI should help you think, not think for you. AI tools may be used to help generate ideas, frame problems, and perform research. It can be a starting point to your own thought process, analysis, and discovery. Do not use them to do your work for you, e.g., do not enter an assignment question into ChatGPT and copy & paste the response as your answer.
2. The use of AI must be open and documented. The use of any AI in the creation of your work must be declared in your submission and explained.
3. Engage with AI Responsibly and Ethically. Engage with AI technologies responsibly, critically evaluating AI-generated outputs and considering potential biases, limitations, and ethical implications in your analysis and discussions. Ensure that the data used for AI applications is obtained and shared responsibly. Never pass off as your own work generated by AI.
4. You are 100% responsible for your final product. You are the user; if the AI tool makes a mistake, and you use it, then it's your mistake. If you don't know whether a statement about any item in the output is true, then it is your responsibility to research it. If you cannot verify it as factual, you should delete it. You hold full responsibility for AI-generated content. Ideas must be attributed, and sources must be verified.
5. These principles are in effect unless the instructor gives you specific guidelines for an assignment or exam. It is your responsibility to ensure you are following the correct guidelines. Not following them will result in a breach of the Academic Integrity Policy.
6. Data that are confidential or personal should not be entered into generative AI tools. Putting confidential or personal data into these tools exposes you and others to the loss of important information. Therefore, do not do so. See point 3 above.
7. The rules and practices on use of AI may vary from class to class, discipline to discipline. Do not assume that what is acceptable in a computer science class will be acceptable in a philosophy class. It is the student's responsibility to stay informed as to the instructor's expectations. When in doubt, ask.

SoC-Specific Principles for the Use of AI

Please adhere to the following overarching institutional principles for the use of AI systems in any SoC coursework:

- Unless expressly approved by the instructor in writing, AI system outcomes should not be incorporated in final submissions or deliverables. They should solely be employed for process and research purposes.
- Students must properly cite the AI systems and document the pertinent prompts utilized during their process and research in the final assignment outcomes.
- Unless expressly approved by the instructor in writing, refrain from using the names of artists, designers, companies, or brands within the prompts. This is to uphold the artistic integrity of those involved.
- The instructor must ensure equitable access to any AI systems utilized in the course. This means that platforms used by students to meet course requirements must be freely accessible or offered through a UM-provided subscription.

RESPECT AND CIVILITY IN THE CLASSROOM

The School of Communication is committed to providing a safe, comfortable and inclusive learning environment that promotes a culture of respect and civility for everyone. Disruptive, rude, discriminatory, or disrespectful behavior toward the instructor, guest lecturers, or your fellow students will not be tolerated. Students who exhibit disruptive or uncivil behavior will be required to leave the classroom.

UM ACADEMIC INTEGRITY POLICY

Students in this and all UM courses are bound by the University's Academic Integrity Policy. The policy can be reviewed at: <https://fs.miami.edu/assets/pdf/facultysenate/Documents/academic-integrity-policy-final-changes-accepted.pdf>

ACCOMMODATIONS

The University of Miami provides academic accommodations for students with disabilities. For more information, please contact the Office of Disability Services (ODS), Camner Academic Resource Center in Whitten University Center N201 or online at <http://www.umarc.miami.edu/arc/ODS.html>

Please be aware that per ARC policy, students are responsible for providing their instructors with their accommodation letter within the first two weeks of class.

Students who, by nature of a documented disability, require academic accommodations should prepare documentation as outlined by the Office of Disability Services and complete the Accommodations Request Form. Once approved, students will need to request **at least 7 days prior to an exam** if they intend to use their accommodations.

WELL-BEING RESOURCES AND SUPPORT

As you complete your coursework, consider how you can maintain your health and well-being as a top priority. To help you become familiar with the many programs and services available on campus, review the information collected on the Division of Student Affairs Student Well-Being and Resiliency website available at www.miami.edu/well-being. Please reach out to any of the resources on the site if you need support throughout the semester.

Title IX

Title IX states that: "No person in the United States shall, on the basis of sex, be excluded from participation in, be denied the benefits of, or be subjected to discrimination under any education program or activity receiving federal financial assistance."

Sexual harassment of any form is unlawful and prohibited by the University. For more information on the university's policies and procedures regarding Title IX, please visit <https://www.titleix.miami.edu/index.html>.

Academic Integrity Policy Violations:

If a student is reported for an Academic Integrity Policy (AIP) violation in a course, the student may not drop the course to avoid the potential consequences of that violation. The student must go through the AIP process.

FINAL NOTE

The professor reserves the right to interpret and make changes if necessary to the syllabus, grading system, schedule, requirements, and materials for this class.

Course Schedule

Flexibility Clause:

How classes are taught, and things may change as the semester progresses. The instructor reserves the right to modify the class schedule, course requirements, and other class-related policies if circumstances dictate that such changes are necessary. If any changes are made, students will be notified via email as soon as possible, and they also will be posted under announcements on Canvas.

Students should complete the reading assignments listed below **prior to** class.

WEEK 1

Aug. 17: Course introduction and overview of syllabus.

***Try to get the textbook before next Wednesday (Aug. 26). Both the electronic and physical copy of the textbook will suffice.**

Aug. 19: Chapter 1: Public Relations Today
Chapter 2: Careers in Public Relations

***This week – in-class test on student understanding of course syllabus**

WEEK 2

Aug. 24: Chapter 1: Public Relations Today
Chapter 2: Careers in Public Relations

Aug. 26: Chapter 3: The Growth of a Profession & Canvas Briefing

***Due by 11:59 p.m. on Aug. 26: Sign and Upload the Student Acknowledgement Form (the Last two Pages of this Course Syllabus) under Canvas's Assignment Tab**

WEEK 3

Aug. 31: Chapter 5: Ethics and the Law

***Due by 11:59 p.m. on Aug. 31: Quiz #1 on Chapters 1-3 under Canvas's "Quizzes" tab**

Sep. 2: Chapter 5: Ethics and the Law

***Due by 11:59 p.m. on Sep 2: Quiz #2 on Chapter 5 under Canvas's "Quizzes" tab**

WEEK 4

Sep. 7: No Class (Labor Day)

Sep. 9 Chapter 4: Departments and Firms

***Due by 11:59 p.m. on Sep. 9: Individual Assignment #1 – PR Leadership under Canvas’s Assignment Tab**

WEEK 5

Sep. 14 Chapter 4: Departments and Firms

***Due by 11:59 p.m. on Sep. 14: Quiz #3 on Chapter 4 under Canvas’s “Quizzes” tab**

Sep. 16: Chapter 6: Research and Campaign Planning

WEEK 6

Sep. 21:Chapter 6: Research and Campaign Planning

***Due by 11:59 p.m. on Sep. 21: Individual Assignment #2 – CEO View under Canvas’s Assignment Tab**

Sep. 23: Chapter 6: Research and Campaign Planning

WEEK 7

Sep. 28: Chapter 6: Research and Campaign Planning

***Due by 11:59 p.m. on Sep. 28: Quiz #4 on Chapter 6 under Canvas’s “Quizzes” tab**

Sep. 30: Chapter 7: Communication and Measurement

WEEK 8

Oct. 5: Chapter 7: Communication and Measurement

Oct. 7: Chapter 7: Communication and Measurement & Review of Exam One Study Guide

***Due by 11:59 p.m. on Oct. 7: Quiz #5 on Chapter 7 under Canvas’s “Quizzes” tab**

WEEK 9

Oct. 12: No Class (Fall Recess)

Oct. 14: Lecture on “Structure of Argument” & Chapter 9 Public Opinion and Persuasion

WEEK 10

Oct. 19: EXAM ONE

***On the exam day, bring a #2 pencil, an eraser, and your Cane ID card to class, and remember your C-number correctly.**

Oct. 21: Guest Lecture via Zoom (To be determined)

WEEK 11

Oct. 26: Chapter 10 Managing Competition, Conflict, and Crisis

Oct. 28: Chapter 10 Managing Competition, Conflict, and Crisis

***Due by 11:59 p.m. on Oct. 28: Individual Assignment #3 – Chapter 16 under Canvas’s Assignment Tab**

WEEK 12

Nov. 2: Chapter 14: Global Public Relations

Nov. 4: Chapter 14: Global Public Relations
Chapter 18: Nonprofit, Health, and Education

***Due by 11:59 p.m. on Nov. 4: Quiz #6 on Chapter 14 under Canvas’s “Quizzes” tab**

***Due by 11:59 p.m. on Nov. 4: Individual Assignment #4 – Chapter 17 under Canvas’s Assignment Tab**

WEEK 13

Nov. 9: Chapter 18: Nonprofit, Health, and Education

***Due by 11:59 p.m. on Nov. 9: Discussion Leader Assignment #1 – Chapter 15 Corporate Public Relations under Canvas’s Assignment Tab**

Nov. 11: Chapter 15 Corporate Public Relations (Student Discussion Leader Presentation via Zoom)

***Student Presentations will be held via Zoom on Canvas.** Please login in the class Canvas site -- click the Zoom Meeting tab on the left side of the site page - Enter Nov. 11's class zoom meeting

***Due by 11:59 p.m. on Nov. 11: Quiz #7 on Chapter 15 and Chapter 18 under Canvas's "Quizzes" tab**

WEEK 14

Nov. 16: Chapter 11 Traditional Mass Media

Nov. 18: Chapter 12 Online and Social Media

***Due by 11:59 p.m. on Nov. 18: Discussion Leader Assignment #2 – Creativity under Canvas's Assignment Tab**

WEEK 15

Nov. 23: Creativity (Student Presentations via Zoom)
Lecture on "Top 30 things you should have learned in STC 116"
Review of Exam Two Study Guide

***Today's lecture will be held via Zoom on Canvas.** Please login in the class Canvas site -- click the Zoom Meeting tab on the left side of the site page -- Enter Nov. 23's class zoom meeting

Nov. 25: No class (Enjoy a great Thanksgiving!)

WEEK 16

Nov. 30: No Class (Prep for Exam Two) – Class ENDS

Dec. 4 (Friday, 2:00 pm to 4:30 pm): EXAM TWO

***On the exam day, bring a #2 pencil, an eraser, and your Cane ID card to class, and remember your C-number correctly.**

FINAL NOTE

The professor reserves the right to interpret and make changes if necessary to the syllabus, grading system, schedule, requirements, and materials for this class.

Please sign this page electronically, then go to Canvas's Assignment Tab, and upload the signed page there **by Aug. 26, 2026.**

STUDENT ACKNOWLEDGEMENT:

I HAVE RECEIVED AND READ THE SYLLABUS FOR STC 116, SECTION GH, FALL SEMESTER 2026. I ACKNOWLEDGE ALL THE REQUIREMENTS AND INSTRUCTIONS THAT I NEED TO FOLLOW, AS LISTED IN THE SYLLABUS. I HAVE COMPLETED THE PREREQUISITE COURSES LISTED IN THE SYLLABUS OR HAVE HAD THE PROFESSOR SIGN BELOW TO CERTIFY A WAIVER OF THE PREREQUISITES.

SIGNED: _____

PRINT FULL NAME: _____

DATE: _____

PROFESSOR PREREQUISITE WAIVER (IF NEEDED): _____